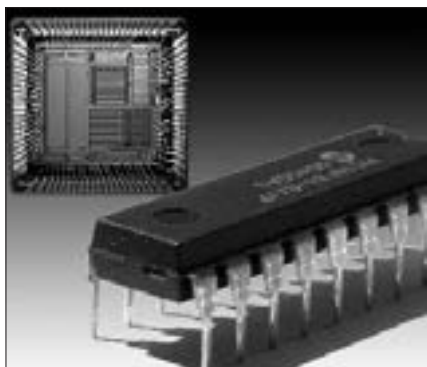


6.1 What Has Changed Since The '80s?

Personal computers came into existence a long time ago, as a result of two path-breaking technological innovations—the Integrated Circuit (IC), and as a consequence of this, the Microprocessor. This was in 1971, when most of us “gamers” were still unborn. The invention of the microprocessor was single-handedly responsible for the beige boxes that sit on our desks today.



The early microprocessor and a regular IC

However, the PC or IBM PC like we called it back then only hit the market 10 years later. This PC shipped with hardware that would probably make us laugh today, but was the top of the line then, and yes, it did cost a fortune. Let's take a look at the IBM 5150 Personal Computer, the big daddy of them all, which actually started the PC revolution.

There were a lot of other PCs available, but this was something else. IBM had already played with the PC markets with their earlier models—the IBM 5100 in 1975, and the IBM Datamaster sometime during 1979 to 1981. But both these models were extremely expensive, and sold poorly.

With the 5150, IBM decided to go radical. While the earlier models used IBM-proprietary processors and data cassettes to store and retrieve information, this model was different. Next page gives you rundown of the specifics the IBM 5150 sported back in 1981 when it was released.